Experiment 8: Storyboarding User Flows with Balsamiq

1. Aim

The objective is to design a high-level storyboard representing the end-to-end user journey for a mobile E-commerce application. Using **Balsamiq**, the goal is to simulate key interaction points from initial product discovery to final payment confirmation, ensuring the logical structure of the app is sound.

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2. Interaction Flow Analysis

The storyboard follows a logical progression of six essential screens:

Screen	Key UI Components	UX Purpose
Homepage	Search bar, promo banners, and featured product thumbnails.	Acts as the primary entry point for user engagement.
Categories	List view of segments (Electronics, Fashion, Books).	Enables efficient filtering based on specific user interests.
Product List	Scrollable items with price, thumbnail, and action buttons.	Facilitates easy comparison of products within a category.
Product Details	Large image placeholder, description, and "Add to Cart" CTA.	Provides deep information to assist in purchase decisions.
Checkout	Cart review and input fields for Name, Address, and Phone.	Allows users to finalize order details before payment.
Payment	Radio buttons for UPI/Card/COD and success confirmation.	Finalizes the transaction and provides order closure.

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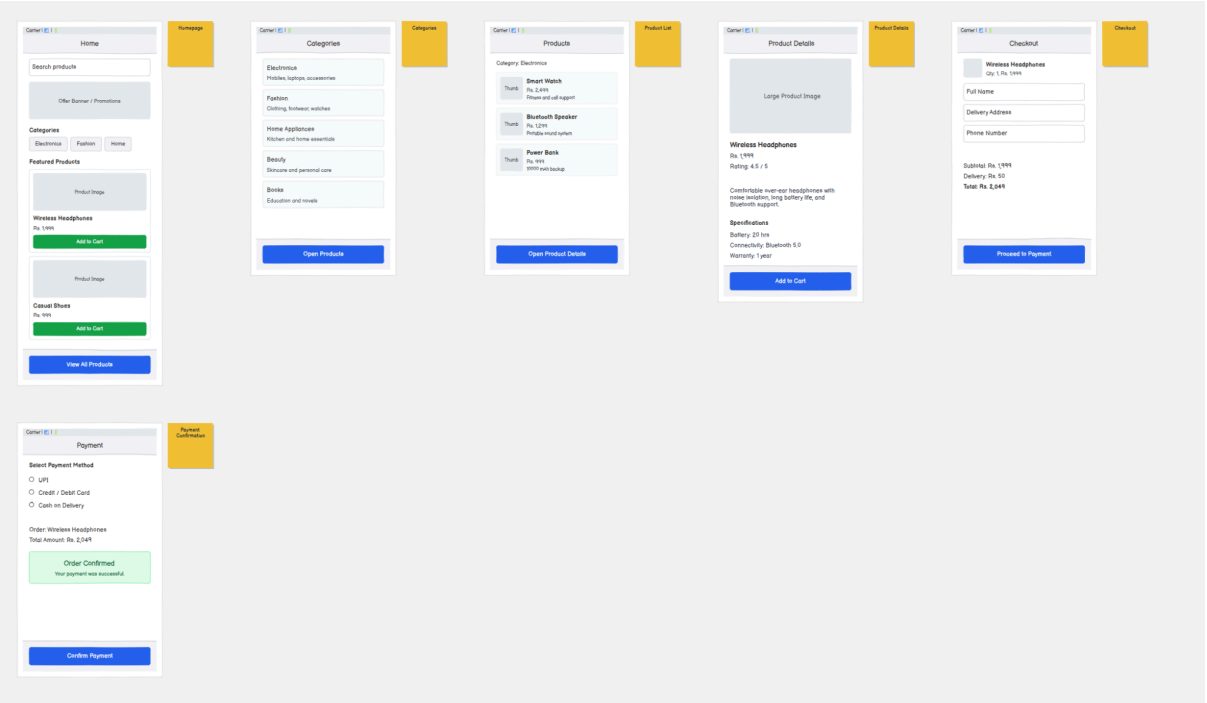
3. Observation

During the design of the storyboard, several key UX observations were made:

- **Low-Fidelity Clarity:** By utilizing a "sketch" aesthetic, the focus remains entirely on **navigation and functionality** rather than visual design, which is essential during the early stages of task analysis.
- **Mental Model Alignment:** The flow follows a standard retail mental model (Browse $\rightarrow$ Select $\rightarrow$ Review $\rightarrow$ Pay), which reduces the learning curve for new users.
- **Form Usability:** The Checkout screen keeps data entry to a minimum (Name, Address, Phone), which is critical for mobile interfaces to prevent user fatigue and cart abandonment.
- **Verification and Closure:** The Payment Confirmation screen acts as a necessary feedback loop, using a "Success" message to assure the user that their action was recorded correctly.
- 

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4. Result

The experiment successfully produced a comprehensive mobile storyboard. By visualizing the interactions, we identified a seamless path from product browsing to transaction completion. The low-fidelity wireframes clearly define the layout for each screen, providing a blueprint for future high-fidelity prototyping.

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5. Conclusion

Low-fidelity storyboarding is a critical step in User Interface Design as it allows for rapid iteration of the user flow. This experiment confirms that a clean, sequential layout focused on primary components is the foundation of a successful mobile retail experience, ensuring the user can reach their goal with minimal friction.